ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 8

SOCIAL SCIENCES

PRACTICE EXAM 1

MARKS: 100 **TIME: 2 hours**

Section A: Geography (50) – maps and globes (scale, degrees and minutes, time), climate (a climate table, factors that influence climate, climate regions), settlement, transport and trade. Section B: History (50) – the Industrial Revolution in Britain, the Mineral Revolution in South Africa, the Scramble for Africa and the First World War.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of TWO sections: SECTION A: Geography (50 marks) and SECTION B: History (50 marks).
2. Answer ALL the questions in BOTH sections.
3. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
4. Read the sources carefully before you answer the questions on them. The sources were written for this examination and are based on historical facts.
5. Show ALL calculations. A non-programmable calculator may be used.

SECTION A: GEOGRAPHY

QUESTION 1: MAPS AND GLOBES

1.1 Give ONE term for each description.

1.1.1 A small model of the Earth

1.1.2 A scale written as 1 : 50 000

1.1.3 A detailed map that shows the height of the land with contour lines

1.1.4 One-sixtieth (1/60) of a degree of latitude or longitude (4)

1.2 (a) Write 33°30′ in decimal degrees. (b) How many minutes are there in 2,25°? (2)

1.3 A map has a scale of 1 : 250 000.

1.3.1 The distance between two towns on the map is 6,4 cm. Calculate the real distance in kilometres. (2)

1.3.2 A road is 30 km long. How long will it be on this map? (2)

1.3.3 Write the scale as a word scale. (1)

1.4 The Earth turns 15° of longitude every hour. Town A is at 30°E and Town B is at 0°. When it is 14:00 (sun time) in Town A, what is the sun time in Town B? Show your working. (2)

1.5 Explain the difference between a large-scale map and a small-scale map. (2)

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QUESTION 2: CLIMATE

2.1 Explain the difference between *weather* and *climate*. (2)

2.2 The table shows the average monthly temperature and rainfall of Town X in South Africa.

Month	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Temperature (°C)	20	20	18	16	13	10	10	13	16	18	19	20
Rainfall (mm)	125	90	80	50	20	5	5	6	25	70	110	120

2.2.1 Which months are the warmest? (1)

2.2.2 Calculate the annual temperature range. (2)

2.2.3 Calculate the total annual rainfall. (2)

2.2.4 Does Town X receive summer rainfall or winter rainfall? (1)

2.2.5 Name a region of South Africa that could have this type of climate. (1)

2.3 Explain how each factor influences climate: (a) altitude (height above sea level); (b) distance from the sea; (c) ocean currents – use Durban and Port Nolloth as examples. (6)

2.4 Give TWO characteristics of a Mediterranean climate and name the part of South Africa that has this climate. (3)

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QUESTION 3: SETTLEMENT, TRANSPORT AND TRADE

3.1 Explain the difference between rural and urban settlements. (2)

3.2 Explain what is meant by the *site* and the *situation* of a settlement. (2)

3.3 Name TWO land-use zones in a city and describe each one. (4)

3.4 Give TWO problems caused by rapid urbanisation. (2)

3.5 Give TWO advantages of transporting heavy goods such as coal by rail rather than by road. (2)

3.6 (a) What is the difference between exports and imports? (b) Name ONE product that South Africa exports. (3)

3.7 Name ONE major seaport in South Africa. (1)

3.8 What is an informal settlement? (1)

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TOTAL SECTION A: [50]

SECTION B: HISTORY

QUESTION 4: THE INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION IN BRITAIN

Read Source A and answer the questions.

SOURCE A: Children in the cotton mills

In the early 1800s many children in British textile mills worked 12 to 14 hours a day. Some were as young as six. They crawled under moving machines to clean them or to tie broken threads, and accidents were common. In 1833 the British Parliament passed a Factory Act which said that children under the age of nine were not allowed to work in textile mills, and which limited the working hours of older children.

4.1 How many hours a day did many children work in the mills? (1)

4.2 How young were some of the child workers? (1)

4.3 Give TWO dangers that children faced in the mills. (2)

4.4 Why did factory owners like to employ children? Give TWO reasons. (2)

4.5 What did the Factory Act of 1833 say about child workers? (2)

4.6 Which inventor improved the steam engine in the 1700s, making it much more efficient? (1)

4.7 Explain how steam power changed the way goods were produced. (2)

4.8 Give TWO reasons why Britain was the first country to industrialise. (2)

4.9 Explain what urbanisation was during the Industrial Revolution, and give ONE problem it caused in the cities. (3)

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QUESTION 5: THE MINERAL REVOLUTION IN SOUTH AFRICA

Read Source B and answer the questions.

SOURCE B: Diamonds at Kimberley

In 1867 a young boy found a shiny stone on a farm near the Orange River. It turned out to be a diamond, which was later called the Eureka. By 1871 thousands of diggers had rushed to the area around present-day Kimberley. As the mines grew deeper, the small claims of individual diggers were bought up by larger companies. In 1888 Cecil John Rhodes formed De Beers Consolidated Mines, which soon controlled almost all the diamond production at Kimberley.

5.1 In which year was the first diamond found? (1)

5.2 What name was given to this diamond? (1)

5.3 Why were small claims bought up by large companies as the mines became deeper? (2)

5.4 Who formed De Beers Consolidated Mines, and in which year? (2)

5.5 De Beers soon controlled almost all diamond production. What is this kind of control called? Explain the term. (2)

5.6 Where and in which year was gold discovered on a large scale in South Africa? (2)

5.7 Which city grew up around the gold mines? (1)

5.8 Explain what migrant labour was, and give TWO effects it had on African families. (3)

5.9 Why did mine owners house African workers in closed compounds? (2)

5.10 Give ONE way in which taxes such as the hut tax forced African men to work on the mines. (1)

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QUESTION 6: THE SCRAMBLE FOR AFRICA AND THE FIRST WORLD WAR

6.1 The Scramble for Africa

6.1.1 What happened at the Berlin Conference of 1884–1885? (2)

6.1.2 Give TWO reasons why European countries wanted colonies in Africa. (2)

6.1.3 Name the TWO African countries that were still independent in 1914. (2)

6.1.4 At which battle in 1896 did Ethiopia defeat Italy? (1)

6.2 Read Source C and answer the questions.

SOURCE C: The sinking of the SS Mendi

On 21 February 1917 the troopship SS Mendi sank in thick fog near the Isle of Wight, off the south coast of England, after it was struck by another ship, the SS Darro. More than 600 men of the South African Native Labour Corps died. They had volunteered to work behind the battle lines in France, but black South Africans were not allowed to carry weapons in the war.

6.2.1 On which date did the SS Mendi sink? (1)

6.2.2 What caused the ship to sink? (1)

6.2.3 Who were the men on the Mendi, and why were they going to France? (2)

6.2.4 Why were black South Africans not allowed to carry weapons? What does this tell us about South Africa at the time? (2)

6.2.5 Why is it important for South Africans to remember the Mendi today? (1)

6.2.6 Explain TWO long-term causes of the First World War. (2)

6.2.7 Which event in Sarajevo in June 1914 triggered the war? (1)

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TOTAL SECTION B: [50]

TOTAL: 100

END OF QUESTION PAPER